AGA KHAN UNIVERSITY EXAMINATION BOARD

HIGHER SECONDARY SCHOOL CERTIFICATE

CLASS XII

ANNUAL EXAMINATIONS (THEORY) 2025

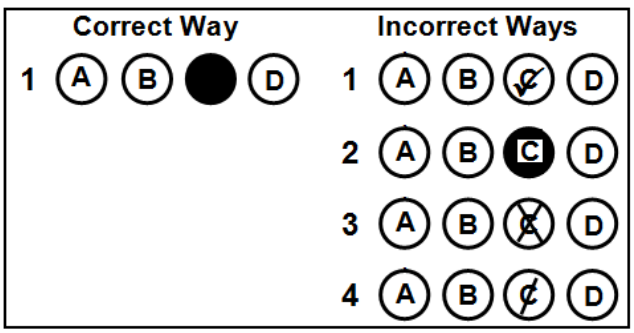
English Compulsory Paper I

Time: 55 minutes Marks: 40

AKU-EB Annual Examinations 2025 for Teaching & Learning only

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Read each question carefully.
2. Answer the questions on the separate answer sheet provided. DO NOT write your answers on the question paper.
3. There are 100 answer numbers on the answer sheet. Use answer numbers 1 to 40 only.
4. In each question, there are four choices A, B, C, D. Choose ONE. On the answer grid, black out the circle for your choice with a pencil as shown below.



Candidate's Signature

5. If you want to change your answer, ERASE the first answer completely with a rubber, before blacking out a new circle.
6. DO NOT write anything in the answer grid. The computer only records what is in the circles.

Listening Comprehension Section

In this section, you will hear two passages. Each one will be played two times.

Listen carefully to the first passage and then read questions 1 to 10. You will have two minutes' reading time.

The passage will be played one more time. You can make notes on your question paper.

When the passage has finished, enter your answers on your separate answer sheet. You will have three minutes to record your answers.

Follow the instructions on the front page of Paper I to show which of the options, A, B, C, or D, you have selected for each question.

Listening Passage I

The speaker talks about communication skills.

Source: Adapted from an article on www.proofhub.com

Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

AKU-EB Annual Examinations 2025 for Teaching & Learning only

1. The speaker begins the heard passage by

   A. stating the importance of communication skills.
   B. describing how people struggle with daily tasks.
   C. asking whether the listener struggles in communicating.
   D. comparing good and bad communication skills of the listener.

2. '...this doesn't mean that you have reached the end of the road.'

   In the given sentence from the heard passage, the phrase 'end of the road' means that the

   A. person is dead.
   B. road has ended.
   C. road is of bad quality.
   D. person's situation is very bad.

3. In the beginning of the heard passage, the speaker generally states that to have good communication skills we should

   A. develop abilities for effective information sharing.
   B. depend solely on natural communication abilities.
   C. have an impact on people without conversing.
   D. share what people only want to listen to.

4. According to the information in the given passage, people would like to talk to us again due to

   A. similarities between us and them.
   B. our ability to listen to them.
   C. their need of being with us.
   D. our popularity only.

5. The speaker states that we react to people when we feel annoyed by them.

   All of the following reactions as a result of the annoyance were mentioned by the speaker EXCEPT

   A. arguing with people.
   B. shouting at people.
   C. avoiding people.
   D. killing people.

6. The speaker mentions that to develop our writing skills we need to

   A. explore our writing styles.
   B. solve various problems.
   C. take writing courses.
   D. maintain a journal.

7. Based on the information in the heard passage, empathy is described as

   A. comprehending others' emotions.
   B. exploring our own emotional problems.
   C. a technique used to create creative stories.
   D. a way to persuade others to always agree with you.

8. Based on the information in the given passage, the adjective that BEST describes the passage is

   A. argumentative.
   B. comparative.
   C. informative.
   D. innovative.

9. The speaker presents information through

   A. personal opinions.
   B. recommendations.
   C. statistical data.
   D. references.

10. A suitable title for the heard passage could be

   A. '*Balancing our Personal and Professional Lives*'.
   B. '*How to Create Engaging Content*'.
   C. '*Strengthening Interactions*'.
   D. '*How to be Empathetic*'.

Annual AKU-EB Examinations 2025 For Teaching & Learning only

Now, we will play the second passage. It will also be played two times.

Listen carefully to the first playing, and then read questions 11 to 20. You will have two minutes' reading time.

The passage will be played one more time. You can make notes on your question paper.

When the passage has finished, enter your answers on your separate answer sheet. You will have three minutes to record your answers.

Listening Passage II

In this passage, the speaker talks about Genghis Khan's tomb.

Source: Adapted from '*Why Genghis Khan's Tomb Cannot Be Found*' by BBC Travel

Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

11. The activities of the speaker, as mentioned in the beginning of the speech, indicate that she is

    A. travelling alone.
    B. a native of Mongolia.
    C. a horse-riding enthusiast.
    D. travelling with a group of tourists.

12. The speaker says, "Ömnögovi Province is endless by car." She means that

    A. it is very big.
    B. it is very small.
    C. she is near its end.
    D. her journey has just begun.

13. The FIRST information given about Genghis Khan is that he

    A. was a great hero.
    B. conquered the world on horseback.
    C. pioneered the use of postal services.
    D. was involved in kidnapping and bloodshed.

14. Genghis Khan ruled everything between the Pacific Ocean and the Caspian Sea. The information given IMMEDIATELY after this is that he

    A. was buried by his army as per their wishes.
    B. was the greatest war hero of Mongolia.
    C. conquered the world and civilised it.
    D. wished his gravesite to be concealed.

15. According to the speaker, when Genghis Khan was buried, his soldiers rode 1,000 horses over his grave. This was done PRIMARILY to

    A. hide the grave.
    B. show disrespect.
    C. express their grief.
    D. honour the emperor.

16. Which evidence presented by the speaker MOST closely indicates that Genghis Khan is respected widely across Mongolia in the current era?

    A. His deeds are taught in schools.
    B. His face is on the Mongolian currency.
    C. His bravery is considered unparalleled.
    D. His contributions have been documented.

Annual AKU-EB Examinations 2025 For Teaching & Learning only

17. At the end of the speech, the speaker says that the Mongolians

    A. find it difficult to explain to outsiders why Genghis Khan's tomb is sacred.
    B. associate Genghis Khan's burial site with his ancestral home.
    C. want to respect Genghis Khan's wish about his burial.
    D. respect Genghis Khan due to his achievements.

18. The speaker gives LEAST information about

    A. the respect people give to Genghis Khan.
    B. the legend of Genghis Khan's grave.
    C. Genghis Khan's personal life.
    D. Genghis Khan's victories.

19. The speaker's attitude towards Genghis Khan can be described as

    A. pitiful.
    B. critical.
    C. doubtful.
    D. respectful.

20. The subject matter of the heard passage is

    A. a memoir (biography).
    B. the environment.
    C. religion.
    D. politics.

AKU-EB Annual Examinations 2025 for Teaching & Learning only

Reading Comprehension Section

You have 30 minutes' time for this section. This section has two reading passages; each followed by 10 multiple choice questions. You are advised to spend 15 minutes on each of the given passages.

Read the passage carefully and then answer the multiple choice questions which follow:

Reading Passage I

Mathematics plays a vital role in our lives, touching us in various ways from morning till night.

Firstly, maths helps us develop essential problem-solving skills. It encourages critical thinking and logical reasoning, enabling us to tackle challenges effectively. By breaking down complex problems into smaller, manageable steps, math equips us with the tools to find solutions. Whether it's calculating the best route to school or solving equations, math empowers us to analyse situations, make informed decisions, and overcome obstacles.

Secondly, maths is all around us in our daily lives. It assists us in managing our personal finances, such as budgeting and understanding interest rates. We use maths when measuring ingredients for a recipe or calculating discounts during shopping. Basic numeracy skills or fundamental maths calculations, including addition, subtraction, multiplication, and division, are essential for everyday tasks like calculating change, estimating travel time, and organising schedules. Maths is a practical tool that helps us navigate the world with confidence and make smart choices in our personal and professional lives.

Lastly, maths serves as the foundation for various careers and fields of study. It is the language of science, enabling us to explore and understand the natural world. From physics to astronomy, math allows us to describe and predict the behaviour of the universe. Moreover, maths underpins technological advancements, from coding algorithms to designing efficient systems and constructing complex structures. In engineering, finance, medicine, and computer science, math provides the necessary skills to innovate, solve problems, and contribute to society's progress.

In conclusion, maths is not just a subject we study in school; it is a fundamental aspect of our lives. It enhances our problem-solving abilities, supports our decision-making processes, and enables us to navigate the complexities of the world. With maths, we gain practical skills for managing our finances, making accurate measurements, and understanding data. Moreover, math opens doors to diverse career opportunities and helps us contribute to scientific discoveries and technological advancements. Embracing the importance of math empowers us to unlock our potential, think critically, and make informed choices that shape our lives and the world around us.

Source: This text is generated through Chat-GPT and verified for content.

Annual Examinations 2025 AKU-EB for Teaching & Learning only

Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

21. According to the information in the given passage, maths can also be used to solve real-life problems. Which of the given statements from the passage FIRST validates this statement?

    A. Math is all around us in our daily lives.
    B. Math is not just a subject we study in school.
    C. Math is a practical tool that helps us navigate the world.
    D. Math serves as the foundation for various careers and fields of study.

22. All of the following numeracy skills are mentioned in the passage EXCEPT

    A. algebra.
    B. addition.
    C. subtraction.
    D. multiplication.

23. The term ‘foundation’ in line 14 can be replaced with

    A. basis.
    B. bottom.
    C. justification.
    D. architecture.

24. In line 18, all the following nouns are suited to describe the underlined terms EXCEPT

    A. disciplines.
    B. points.
    C. fields.
    D. areas.

25. Another cohesive device similar to ‘In conclusion’ (line 20) in the given passage is

    A. Lastly.
    B. Firstly.
    C. Whether.
    D. Moreover.

26. In line 24, the term ‘math opens doors’ is used contextually as a/ an

    A. personification.
    B. hyperbole.
    C. metaphor.
    D. idiom.

AKU-EB Annual Examinations 2025 for Teaching & Learning only

27. It can be inferred from the passage that

    A. we can learn ways to live life through studying maths.
    B. math should be studied only by mathematicians.
    C. we should only study math in school.
    D. math is a very complex subject.

28. The MAIN purpose of the author is to

    A. explain the importance of maths.
    B. compare different aspects of maths.
    C. persuade the reader into being a math teacher.
    D. discuss the ways in which maths affects technology.

29. The tone of the given passage is

    A. ecstatic.
    B. persuasive.
    C. humorous.
    D. monotonous.

30. The text type of the given passage is

    A. reflective.
    B. analytical.
    C. argumentative.
    D. communicative.

AKU-EB Annual Examinations 2025 for Teaching & Learning only

Now read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.

Reading Passage II

When the English archaeologist Howard Carter discovered the royal tomb of Tutankhamen in Egypt in November 1922, it took fully eight days to unwrap the mummified body of the young king from 16 layers of linen. To get at the body, amulets and jewellery among the bandages and more violent methods were employed by Carter and his team such as heated knives to take off the golden mask from the decapitated skull of the king. The linen, however, was considered by Carter an impediment to be brushed aside, an opinion that would have horrified the ancient Egyptians to whom linen was imbued with powerful even magical meaning. Mummification was associated in their art with the divine. It was what made mummies sacred.

This is just one of the many illuminating stories contained in '*The Golden Thread*', a thematic history of fabrics by design and culture writer Kassia St Clair who points out that the world's earliest fabrics were made by human hand 34,000 years ago. Social divisions, St Clair emphasises, have long been codified using cloth. This means that luxurious display through the fabric of one's clothing was a way of expressing power. Furthermore, language and cloth are interwoven with each other. In other words, the interface between text and textile is fertile ground for literary critics who 'unpick', 'piece together' or 'unravel', while other phrases are also rooted in textile crafts like 'being on tenterhooks' or 'a knotty problem'.

Like silk, wool was a money spinner in Europe. "The wool trade made them wealthy in the 12th and 13th century and also made them worldly", comments St Clair. Wool encouraged speculation and profiteering and widened the gap between the richest and poorest. As wool defined the social status of different groups throughout history, lace also has its own intricate history and cult status. A craft associated with women and incredibly complex designs, the fabric was passed down across many generations. It was a luxury item used to display wealth, taste and rank.

The pre-eminent fabric of the West, however, was cotton. The story of cotton, the fortunes made and the horror of the African slave market and the fact that from the 1790s to the 1860s, the lives of many millions of American slaves were determined by the cotton trade are well documented. Even today cotton clothing makes shocking demands on the environment as a single pair of jeans requires 11,000 litres of water. The book concludes that the fabrics we choose and where we get them from still have consequences on the lives of those who produce them.

Source: Adapted from '*The Golden Thread: How Fabric Changed History – a Riveting Yarn*' by Deirdre McQuillan.

Annual AKU-EB Examinations 2025 for Teaching & Learning only

Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

31. The reason for the author beginning the passage with the discovery of an Egyptian mummy is to

    A. highlight the texture of linen.
    B. demonstrate the importance of linen to Egyptians.
    C. propagate the importance of archaeological discoveries.
    D. stress on the ethical implications of tampering with historical artefacts.

32. According to the author of the given passage, and ancient Egyptians, Howard Carter's actions can be described as

    A. justified.
    B. cautious.
    C. unethical.
    D. entertaining.

33. According to the information in the given passage, wool can be described as a/ an

    A. environmentally friendly item.
    B. asset to gain profit.
    C. historic item.
    D. heavy fabric.

34. Suppose you are rewriting the given passage. You want to include some aspects of language in the passage and describe how the fashion industry is a 'community'. Which of the following terms would be BEST suited to be part of the article?

    A. Close knit family
    B. Weaving dynasties
    C. Shades of tradition
    D. Unravelling Needles

35. The last paragraph's focus is MAINLY on the

    A. jean producing industries.
    B. historical significance of cotton.
    C. importance of the Western world.
    D. production of slavery in the West.

36. Which of the following fabrics have NOT been mentioned in the given passage?

    A. Silk
    B. Lace
    C. Velvet
    D. Cotton

AKU-EB Annual Examinations 2025 for Teaching & Learning only

37. It can be inferred from the passage that

A. we should be knowledgeable about history.
B. we should be passionate about the textile industry.
C. the textile industry can be very harmful for all humans.
D. the history of some fabrics shows the class struggle of people.

38. The overall tone of the passage is identified as

A. concerned.
B. humorous.
C. regretful.
D. neutral.

39. The information presented in the given passage is MAINLY through

A. opinions.
B. reflections.
C. descriptions.
D. argumentation.

40. The text type of the given passage exemplifies a

A. news report.
B. book review.
C. documentary.
D. research article.

AKU-EB Annual Examinations 2025 for Teaching & Learning only

END OF PAPER

Please use this page for rough work

AKU-EB
Annual Examinations 2025
for Teaching & Learning only